COUTURE SANCTUM
Interiors of Rahul Mishra's flagship in Mumbai (left and right); Rahul Mishra, Divya Bhatt Mishra and architect Rooshad Shroff (bottom)





BUILT FOR BESPOKE

The country's top fashion and jewellery houses are teaming with architects and designers to reimagine their stores as a total sensory experience

By **RIDHI KALE**

Photographs courtesy BRAND STORES

Retail therapy is evolving. It's no longer about dodging hangers in cramped quarters; it's about stepping into a brand's literal psyche. Across India, designers are ditching the boutique label in favour of living museums and celestial galleries. From Mumbai's storied corners to Delhi's sun-drenched sanctuaries, these flagships prioritise atmosphere over transaction. Here is a look at the environments turning high fashion into high architecture.

A Cut Above

Picture Rahul Mishra's 7,500 sq ft flagship at Mumbai's Horniman Circle as a walk through an exquisite sketchbook. Designed with architect Rooshad Shroff, the journey starts in a silent, garment-free vestibule housing muslin swatches and botanical drawings. Surfaces are treated with the same rigour as Mishra's embroidery, featuring wood marquetry and etched marble. It builds to a grand finale: a soaring chamber with a constellation of handcrafted metal birds suspended mid-air. As Shroff puts it, "The store needed to become a physical extension of Rahul's universe, immersing visitors in a rich tapestry of storytelling."

